

Andrea Novellis

+39 329 977 5225
+94 074 075 0327
✉ novellis.andrea@gmail.com
🌐 andreanovellis.com
📄 andrea-novellis-39175b213

Academic Positions

- 07/2026–09/2026 **Research Associate**, *University of Naples “L’Orientale”*, Naples (Italy)
ITALIM project. Research on the international politics of food security, food-related political vulnerability, and conflict in the Middle East and North Africa.
- 10/2024–10/2025 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *University of Naples “L’Orientale”*, Naples (Italy)
Project: RAP-RISK (Political Risk Measurement: Risks and Opportunities). Research on early warning systems, crisis recognition failures, and political risk analysis. Case studies: Sri Lanka, Israel, Palestine.
- 10/2019–05/2024 **Doctoral Researcher**, *University of Milan*, Milan (Italy)
PhD in Political Science. Research on ethnic conflict, rebel political institutions, and governance in NE Syria, Sri Lanka, and Nepal. Fieldwork in Turkey, KRI-Iraq, Sri Lanka. Training in qualitative and quantitative methods.

Research Affiliations

- 09/2026–11/2026 **Visiting Postdoctoral Researcher**, *Institute of Federalism, University of Fribourg*, Fribourg (Switzerland)
University of Fribourg Scholarship; host: Prof. Eva Maria Belser.
- 2026– **Associated Member**, *Center on the International Politics of Food Security (CIPFS)*, Interuniversity research centre, University of Pavia (Italy)
- 2025–2026 **Fellow**, *Civil War Paths – Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil Wars*, University of York (UK)

Consulting & Professional Experience

- 07/2025 **Consultant**, *ACAPS*, Switzerland / Remote
Provided expert review and recommendations on a report on humanitarian risk in Syria.
- 11/2024–03/2025 **Consultant**, *National Peace Council*, Colombo (Sri Lanka)
Staff training on research methods.
- 08/2023–05/2025 **Consultant**, *Arci (NGO)*, Italy / Remote
Country of Origin Information (COI) research; staff training on asylum procedures and socio-political context.
- 02/2021–07/2022 **Researcher & Consultant**, *Operazione Colomba – Nonviolent Peace Corps*, Italy / Remote
Research on rebel groups and human rights in North-East Syria.

Teaching

- 2026 **Course Instructor**, *Bandaranaike Centre for International Studies (BCIS)*, Colombo (Sri Lanka)
Short course: *Rethinking Peace, Conflict, and the Post-Liberal Order*.
- 2022–2023 **Teaching Assistant**, MA course “**Global Geopolitics**”, *University of Milan*, Milan (Italy)

Education

- 2024 **PhD in Political Studies**, *University of Milan*, Italy
Dissertation: *Why Fight When You Can Rule Together? Rebel Power-Sharing During Civil Wars*.
- 2014–2017 **MA in Comparative International Relations**, *Ca’ Foscari University of Venice*, Italy
Final grade: 110/110 *cum laude*. Visiting Graduate Student, University of Toronto (2016–2017). Erasmus+, Boğaziçi University (2015–2016).

Grants

- 2026 MAECI Study and Research Mission Grant, Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation
Awarded for invited academic activities at the Bandaranaike Centre for International Studies, Colombo (Sri Lanka).
- 2025–2026 ITALIM: Italy and the International Politics of Food Security, Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MAECI)
Principal proposal writer; awarded competitive inter-university research grant.

Publications

- 2026 Hanau Santini, Ruth, and Andrea Novellis. "Paradigm Lock-In and Strategic Surprise: Explaining Israel's October 7 Intelligence Failure." *Middle East Policy*.
- Conditional acceptance Novellis, Andrea. "Early Warning Failure in Sri Lanka: Institutional Knowledge Filters and the 2022 Polycrisis." *Review of International Studies*.
- 2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Programmatic Incompatibility: Ideology, Trust and the Limits of Rebel Cooperation Among Syria's Kurdish Actors." *Civil Wars*.
- 2026 Corradi, Edoardo, and Andrea Novellis. "Earning, Allocating, Providing: The Financial and Budget Management of the Democratic Autonomous Administration of North and East Syria." *Civil Wars*.
- 2026 Novellis, Andrea. "The Divided Self: How Ideological Compartmentalization Drives Rebel-to-Party Success in Sri Lanka." *Democratization*.
- 2025 Novellis, Andrea, and Davide Grasso. "Introduction – Exploring the Kurdish Movement: Power Relations, Historical Dynamics and Theoretical Perspectives." *Partecipazione e Conflitto* 18(2): 384–394.
- 2018 Novellis, Andrea. "The Rise of Feminism in the PKK." *Zanj: The Journal of Critical Global South Studies*.
- 2018 Novellis, Andrea. "An Alternative to Nationalism: The Kurdish Movement in Turkey." *Occhiali. Rivista sul Mediterraneo islamico*.

Dissertation

- 2024 Novellis, Andrea. *Why Fight When You Can Rule Together? Rebel Power-Sharing During Civil Wars*. PhD diss., University of Milan.

Books / chapters

- 2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Syria: Food Security and Stability in the Post-Assad Transition." In Ruth Hanau Santini, ed., *Food Sovereignty and Food Security: The Increasing Weaponisation of Food*, 105–124. Naples: UniorPress.
- 2025 Novellis, Andrea. "Le Relazioni Esterne del DAANES nell'Interregno Siriano" ["The External Relations of DAANES in the Syrian Interregnum"]. In *La guerra civile siriana*. Rome: Carocci.

Research reports and policy papers

- 2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Early Warning and Sri Lanka's Economic Crisis." In Ruth Hanau Santini, Andrea Novellis, Rajni Gamage, and Devyani Chaturvedi, eds., *Humanitarianism, Development Assistance, Early Warning and Political Violence in South Asia. ISAS Special Report 37*.

Editorial Work

- 2026– Co-editor, Special Issue "Informality and Global Political Orders: Mechanisms of Governance Across States, Conflicts, and Diplomacy", *Cambridge Review of International Affairs*, forthcoming; co-editor, with Ruth Hanau Santini, Rajni Gamage, and Devyani Chaturvedi, *Humanitarianism, Development Assistance, Early Warning and Political Violence in South Asia, ISAS Special Report 37*, Institute of South Asian Studies, National University of Singapore.
- 2025– Member, Academic Advisory Board, *Vienna Kurdish Studies Yearbook*.
- 2025 Co-editor, Special Issue "Exploring the Kurdish Movement: Power Relations, Historical Dynamics and Theoretical Perspectives". *Partecipazione e Conflitto* 18(2).

Conference Organization

- 05/2026 Workshop *Food Security and Political Power in and beyond the MENA Region*, University of Naples "L'Orientale", Naples (Italy), 12 May 2026.

- 03/2026 *RISC Study Days*, Italian Kurdish Studies Network (RISC), University of Turin, Italy. International conference on Kurdish studies.
- 09/2023 *The Kurds and the Others*, University of Salento, Lecce (Italy). Co-organizer of the international conference “The Kurds and the Others”, University of Salento, 28–29 Sep 2023.

Selected Conference Panel Chair

- 2025 Panel: “Beyond Sectarianism: Regional Politics and Conflict Realignment in the Middle East”, SISP Conference, Naples (Italy), 4–6 Sep 2025.
- 2024 Panel: “Turkey Between the Past and Today’s World. Who’s and How’s the Other?” SeSaMO Conference, University of Cagliari, 26 Sep 2024.
- 2024 Panel: “The Politics of Stabilisation and State Building”, Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Edinburgh, 4–6 Sep 2024.
- 2022 Webinar: “Reflectivity and Research Ethics in Conflict Areas. Field Experiences from Kurdistan”, SeSaMO Webinar Series “Research and the Middle East”, 14 Dec 2022.
- 2022 Panel: “Kurdish Rojava, Autonomous Administration of North East Syria: propaganda or successful institutional experiment?”, SeSaMO Conference, University of Naples L’Orientale, 22–24 Jun 2022.

Selected Conference Presentations and Workshops

- 09/2026 “Selective Violence after Rebel Victory: Armed-Order Consolidation in Post-Assad Syria, December 2024–September 2026”, Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Glasgow, Glasgow (UK), 10 Sep 2026.
- 09/2026 “Conflict Termination and Authoritarian Opposition Management in Turkey”, SISP Conference, University of Trento, Trento (Italy), 4 Sep 2026.
- 09/2026 “Stateness between Despotic and Infrastructural Power in the Post-2011 UAE, KSA and Türkiye: Authoritarian Infrastructural Power”, SISP Conference, University of Trento, Trento (Italy), 4 Sep 2026.
- 08/2026 “A Veneer of Reconciliation? Youth Peacebuilding in the Shadow of Sri Lanka’s Victor’s Peace”, ISA South Asia Conference, Colombo (Sri Lanka), 6 Aug 2026.
- 07/2026 Participant, WS AB: “Self-Determination in an Era of Democratic Shifts: New Directions in the Study of Secession, Autonomy and Minority Protection”, 13th European Workshops in International Studies, Izmir University of Economics, Turkey, 1–3 July 2026.
- 2026 “The Authoritarian Settlement Playbook: Learning and Conflict Management in Turkey”, Kurdish Studies Conference, London School of Economics, London (UK), 29 Apr–1 May 2026.

Selected Conference Presentations and Workshops (continued)

- 2025 “Evaluating Early Warning Systems in Policy-Driven Crises”, IPSA World Congress, Seoul (South Korea).
- 2025 “Earning, Allocating, Providing: The Financial and Budget Management of the DAANES”, 2nd International Kurdish Studies Conference, LSE, London (UK).
- 2025 “A House Divided Against Itself? Ideology, Trust, and the Limits of Kurdish Cooperation in the Syrian Civil War”, 4th International Kurdish Studies Conference, University of Kurdistan Hewler, Hewler (Iraq).
- 2025 “The Gaza Crisis and the Limitations of Predictive Systems in Protracted Conflict”, Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Kent (UK).
- 2025 “The Failure of Israeli Early Warning on October 7: What Lies Behind It?”, SISP Conference, Università Federico II, Naples (Italy).
- 2024 “Syrian Kurdish Alliance Politics: Examining the PYD–KNC Wartime Negotiations Through a Multi-Actor Lens”, SISP Conference, University of Trieste (Italy).
- 2024 “From Rebellion to Realpolitik: The JVP’s Role in Post-Conflict Sri Lanka”, Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Edinburgh (UK).
- 2024 “A Community Reimagined: The Sri Lanka Muslim Congress and the Shaping of Muslim Identity”, Maydan–SeSaMO Conference, Sapienza University of Rome (Italy).
- 2023 “Beyond the Battlefield: Alliance Formation and Governance Strategies in the Syrian Civil War”, SISP Conference, University of Genoa (Italy).
- 2023 “Displacement in the Shadow of Conflict: The Case of Shaqlawa’s Christians in the Kurdistan Region of Iraq”, Conflict Research Society Conference, King’s College London (UK).
- 2023 “Alliance Formation and Rebel Co-Governance in North-East Syria: The Case of the PYD and the Syriac Union Party”, ECPR General Conference, Charles University, Prague (Czechia).

Policy & Public Writing

- 2025 “The Paradox of Syria’s New Peace”. *The Loop* (ECPR).
- 2024 “AI and the Erosion of Humanity”. *Groundviews*.
- 2024 “The JVP and Ethnic Relations: Walking a Tightrope to 2024” (Parts 1–3). *Groundviews*.

Languages

Italian	Native speaker.
English	C2 CEFR.
Turkish	B1 CEFR.